

do to food and exercise. Once you're in that mindset of perfection or bust, it can be really difficult to actually be fair and reasonable in your expectations of yourself. Unless you're budgeting for a very, very short-term goal, your setup should honour the fact that you – nobody else but you – are going to have to live with this. It should be liveable with and leave room for enjoyment, and that is what will allow you to build consistency and momentum in your journey, eventually leading you to achieve your financial goals and have a better relationship with money.

It's broadly acknowledged that it is what we repeatedly do that builds our world and our experience of life, rather than single events, and this relentless nature of the life admin and self-care tasks that we have to complete is what can lead us to feel burned out and despondent, which can, in turn, lead to the 'fuck it' mentality that precedes giving up. This is especially true of money management, so we have to find ways and strategies for making those repeated actions easier and incorporating them into our lives in a way that doesn't drain us. Even when we frame taking care of our finances as wellbeing practice, it doesn't mean that it always happens easily or organically, which is where the rituals and routines that we develop in this step will help to keep us engaged and on track.

Habit change – either breaking bad ones or building new ones – is difficult, and has been the subject of much discussion for decades. There are people who swear that there's a set timeframe for making and breaking habits, others who swear